

JAHANGIRNAGAR UNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENT OF ENGLISH

BA (HONOURS) 4TH YEAR FINAL EXAMINATION QUESTION BANK

COURSE CODE: E 413

COURSE TITLE: Research Methods in Applied Linguistics and ELT

Target Stream: Concentration on Applied Linguistics & ELT

Batches Included: 42, 43, 44, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50 (Batch 45 missing)

CURRENT SYLLABUS REFERENCE & SCOPE (Session: 2021–2022, Batch 51)

SYLLABUS TOPICS:

- **Research Concepts & Paradigms:** Definition, nature, ethics, and significance of research; Quantitative, Qualitative, and Mixed-Methods paradigms; Post-positivism, Pragmatism, Participatory paradigms.
- **Research Designs & Traditions:** Narrative Inquiry; Qualitative & Quantitative Case Study; Action Research (Cycles: plan, act, observe, reflect); Grounded Theory; Survey Research (cross-sectional, longitudinal); Experimental & Quasi-experimental designs (pretest-posttest, control groups); Corpus Research; Discourse Analysis & Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA); Ethnography.
- **Research Formulation:** Research problem identification; Objectives; Justification; Research questions vs. hypotheses; Variables (independent, dependent, confounding, extraneous); Delimitations and limitations.
- **Literature Review:** Purpose, search strategies, critical synthesis, and step-by-step procedures.
- **Methodology & Instrumentation:** Sampling techniques (probability vs. non-probability); Instrumentation (questionnaire construction, open/closed items; structured, semi-structured, and unstructured interviews; focus group discussions; observation); Triangulation; Member check.
- **Data Analysis & Statistics:** Descriptive statistics (mean, median, standard deviation); Inferential statistics (Pearson Product-moment correlation r , independent/paired samples T-test, One-way ANOVA, Chi-square, Factor analysis).
- **Documentation & Academic Writing:** Plagiarism detection and prevention; Academic integrity; APA style (7th edition) Reference Lists and In-text citations; Research proposal and dissertation structuring.

SECTION A: BROAD THEORETICAL & METHODOLOGICAL QUESTIONS

Comprehensive essay questions covering research paradigms, traditions, qualitative/quantitative methodologies, and research design.

1. Research Nature, Paradigms & Formulations

1. What is research? Discuss the essential qualities of rigorous academic research. In what ways does research contribute to solving real-world language-related problems in ELT? [50, 43, 42]
2. How do quantitative, qualitative, and mixed-method research approaches differ in their underlying paradigms, purposes, data collection techniques, and analytical procedures? Provide examples from Applied Linguistics. [50, 48, 47, 46, 42]
3. What do you understand by 'research questions'? How do clear and focused research questions guide the research design and methodology? Formulate three research questions on the topic "Challenges and Solutions in Teaching Grammar to Adult Learners". [50]
4. What are variables in research? Discuss with examples independent, dependent, moderator, and extraneous variables. [49]
5. What do you understand by 'research problem'? Discuss the sources and processes of selecting and narrowing down a research problem. [49]
6. Why is 'literature review' important in research? Give a detailed description of the steps followed in conducting a critical literature review. [49, 46, 44, 43]
7. How do research questions differ from research hypotheses? Explicate how and why varied research questions are formulated to conduct a study. [44, 43, 42]
8. What are the different types of research into second/foreign language learning and teaching according to Brown (1988)? Discuss the criteria for good research. [44, 43]

9. What are theoretical and conceptual frameworks? Ascertain the role of theory in second language research. [43, 42]

2. Qualitative & Interpretive Research Traditions

1. What is a case study? How are data generally organized, triangulated, and interpreted in a case study? Point out the scope of using case study-based research in Applied Linguistics and ELT. [50, 48, 47, 46]
2. How is a 'case study' different from 'ethnography'? Explain and exemplify 'intrinsic', 'instrumental', and 'collective' case studies. [49]
3. What are the essential features of 'ethnographic research'? How and why is ethnographic research relevant in investigating classroom culture and language socialization? [49]
4. Explain the research methodology of Narrative Inquiry. What are the research steps involved in a narrative study, and how can a researcher improve its quality and trustworthiness? [47, 46]
5. Define Discourse Analysis. What are the key features of a discourse analysis approach? Explain, with examples, the steps involved in conducting discourse analysis research. [47, 46]

3. Action Research, Mixed Methods & Experimental Designs

1. What are the common phases of Action Research (planning, action, observation, reflection)? Suggest an action research design on the topic "Enhancing EFL learners' speaking fluency through role-play activities". [50, 48, 47, 46]
2. Define Mixed Methods Research. What are timing, weighting, and mixing? Explain Exploratory, Explanatory, Triangulation, and Embedded mixed-methods designs with concrete ELT examples. [48, 47, 46]
3. Explain the concepts of 'independent' and 'dependent' variables. Design a 'post-test only control group' research design on the topic "The effectiveness of two teaching methods (traditional lecture vs. task-based learning) in improving students' speaking skills". [50]
4. Discuss with examples the 'pretest-posttest control group' experimental research design and its threats to internal and external validity. [49]
5. Elaborate on the step-by-step procedures in designing and conducting survey research in applied linguistics. [49]

4. Data Collection Instrumentation & Academic Integrity

1. What is a 'questionnaire'? Design a short questionnaire (8 to 10 items) on the topic "University students' attitudes towards using technology-assisted language learning apps". [50]
2. What are the differences between 'structured' and 'unstructured' interviews? Design ten interview questions (five for teachers and five for students) on the topic "Code-Switching Practices in Bangladeshi English Classrooms: Teachers' and Students' Views". [50]
3. Provide some useful guidelines that should help a researcher create good open-response and closed-response items in a questionnaire. [48]
4. Compare semi-structured interviews with open interviews and structured interviews. What are the qualities of a successful interviewer? [48]
5. Explain key aspects of research that researchers should take into account while conducting a focus group discussion (FGD). [48]
6. What is plagiarism? What are the types and penalties of plagiarism? How can a researcher avoid plagiarism through paraphrasing, summarizing, and ethical citation? [50, 48, 44, 43, 42]

SECTION B: SHORT NOTES & RESEARCH TERMINOLOGY

Short explanatory notes covering research concepts, data instruments, and analytical tools.

Short Notes Collection

1. Primary and Secondary Research [50]
2. Statement of the Problem [50, 44]
3. Literature Review [50, 42]
4. Ethnographic Research Design [50]
5. Longitudinal vs. Cross-sectional Survey [50]
6. Research hypothesis (Directional, Non-directional, Null) [49]
7. Sampling techniques (Random, Stratified, Purposive, Convenience) [49]
8. Questionnaire design [49]
9. Working bibliography [49]
10. Action research cycle [49]
11. Control group and experimental group [49]
12. Plagiarism and academic ethics [49, 43]
13. Variables in second language research [44]
14. Delimitations and limitations of the study [44]
15. Conceptual framework vs. Theoretical framework [44, 42]
16. Writing a research proposal [43]
17. Formulating research objectives [43]
18. Research ethics and informed consent [42]
19. Structure of a research abstract [42]
20. Research paradigms: Post-positivism, Pragmatism, Participatory [46]
21. Parsing and Tagging in corpus analysis of speech [47]
22. Involvement Load Hypothesis in vocabulary research [47]
23. Discourse Completion Task (DCT) in pragmatic research [47]
24. Gardner's socio-educational model of language learning [47]

SECTION C: STATISTICAL PROBLEMS & APA 7TH EDITION EXERCISES

Practical numerical problems, inferential statistical hypothesis testing, and rigorous APA 7th edition referencing tasks.

APA 7th Edition: Reference List Construction [50]

Task: Following the **APA 7th edition** guidelines, create an accurate Reference List from the following scrambled bibliographic entries:

1. **Book:** Author: Rod Ellis; Book title: *The Study of Second Language Acquisition (2nd ed.)*; Year: 2008; Publisher: Oxford University Press; Place: Oxford, UK.
2. **Book:** Authors: Vivian Cook and David Singleton; Book title: *Key Topics in Second Language Acquisition*; Year: 2014; Publisher: Multilingual Matters; Place: Bristol, UK.
3. **Edited Book:** Book Title: *The Handbook of Applied Linguistics*; Publisher: Blackwell Publishing; Year: 2002; Editors: Alan Davies and Catherine Elder; Place: Malden, MA.
4. **Journal Article:** Author: Rod Ellis; Article Title: "The Study of Second Language Acquisition"; Journal: *Oxford Applied Linguistics Series*; Year: 2001; Publisher: Oxford University Press.
5. **Journal Article with Multiple Authors:** Authors: Suresh A. Canagarajah, Sarah Benesch, Brian V. Street; Article Title: "Negotiating the Political in Academic Literacies"; Journal: *Journal of Applied Linguistics*; Year: 2005; Vol. 2, Issue 2, pp. 173–195.
6. **Organizational Author / Report:** Author/Organization: British Council; Book title: *English as a Global Language: Issues and Debates*; Publisher: British Council Publications; Year: 2016; Place: London.
7. **Journal Article with DOI:** Author/Organization: American Council on the Teaching of Foreign Languages (ACTFL); Year: 2016; Article title: "The role of intercultural competence in applied linguistics research and pedagogy"; Journal: *Foreign Language Annals*; Volume/Issue: 49(4); Pages: 654–670; DOI: 10.1111/flan.12234.

APA 7th Edition: In-Text Citation Corrections [50]

Task: Rewrite and correct the following faulty in-text citations according to **APA 7th edition** rules:

- a) According to Smith 2020, second language learners often struggle with pronunciation.
- b) According to Ortega (2013) second language acquisition theories have evolved over the decades.
- c) Studies suggest that pragmatic competence is crucial for communication in ESL settings (Brown2007).
- d) In a study of bilingualism, researchers found positive cognitive effects (Bialystok, 2001, see also pp. 33–35).
- e) According to Larsen-Freeman, language acquisition is influenced by both input and interaction (2008).
- f) Swales and Feak 2012 argue that academic writing is genre-specific.

Statistical Problem: One-Way ANOVA Hypothesis Testing [49]

Problem: You are provided with the test scores of students taught using three different teaching methods:

- **Method A:** 81, 83, 82, 76, 80 ($N = 5$)
- **Method B:** 87, 85, 86, 88, 90 ($N = 5$)
- **Method C:** 91, 92, 93, 95, 94 ($N = 5$)

Task:

1. Conduct a One-Way Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) test to determine if there are statistically significant differences between the teaching methods.
2. Calculate Between-Group Sum of Squares (SSB), Within-Group Sum of Squares (SSW), Degrees of Freedom ($df_{\text{B}} = k-1$, $df_{\text{W}} = N-k$), Mean Squares (MSB, MSW), and the F-ratio ($F = \text{MSB} / \text{MSW}$).
3. Compare the calculated F-ratio to the critical F-value for $\alpha = 0.05$ from the F-distribution table ($df_{\text{B}}=2$, $df_{\text{W}}=12$, Critical $F = 3.89$) and conclude whether the null hypothesis of equal population means can be rejected.
4. State all assumptions made (normality, homogeneity of variance, independence of observations).

Statistical Problem: Pearson Product-Moment Correlation (r) [48]

Problem: What is the Pearson Product-moment correlation coefficient (r)? Calculate r between the following Writing and Speaking test scores obtained by 10 students, and interpret the strength and direction of the relationship:

- **Student 1:** Writing = 25, Speaking = 20
- **Student 2:** Writing = 30, Speaking = 28
- **Student 3:** Writing = 20, Speaking = 16
- **Student 4:** Writing = 15, Speaking = 12
- **Student 5:** Writing = 12, Speaking = 20
- **Student 6:** Writing = 22, Speaking = 12
- **Student 7:** Writing = 16, Speaking = 36
- **Student 8:** Writing = 18, Speaking = 10
- **Student 9:** Writing = 14, Speaking = 14
- **Student 10:** Writing = 18, Speaking = 16

Statistical Problem: Independent Samples T-Test [48]

Problem: In a listening comprehension test, one group received background subject information (Experimental Group) while the other did not (Control Group). Two groups were formed at random.

- **Experimental Group:** $N = 12$, $s = 16.5$, $M = 140$
- **Control Group:** $N = 16$, $s = 12.3$, $M = 120$

Questions:

- a) What is a T-test? When is an independent samples t-test appropriate?
- b) Calculate the t-statistic and determine whether the gain received in listening comprehension is statistically significant at the 0.05 level.

Additional Applied Questions:

- Make a table showing major research areas in L2 reading.
- What is a Language Related Episode (LRE)? Give examples of Implicit Corrective Feedback (ICF) and Explicit Corrective Feedback (ECF) on oral L2 production.
- Mention steps for conducting Genre Analysis in researching writing. Define Frequency and Association in Corpus Analysis.
- Explain Verbal Protocols (Think-aloud) and Eye-tracking in researching L2 reading.